

A

Cardinal numbers

379 = three **hundred** and seventy-nine
 5,084 = five thousand and eighty-four
 2,000,000 = two **million**

2,860 = two **thousand**, eight hundred and sixty
 470,000 = four hundred and seventy thousand
 3,000,000,000 = three **billion**

Language help

There is no plural 's' after *hundred*, *thousand*, *million* and *billion* when they are part of a number. When we are talking generally, they are plural, e.g. **thousands** of people, **millions** of insects.

B

Dates

With dates, we write them and say them in a different way. We can write **4 June** or **June 4th**, but say **the fourth of June** or **June the fourth**.

We can write **21 May** or **May 21st**, but say the **twenty-first of May** or **May the twenty-first**.

1997 = **nineteen ninety-seven**; 2016 = **two thousand and sixteen** or **twenty sixteen**

Common mistakes

The **seventh** of April (NOT The seven April); the **fourth** question (NOT the ~~four~~ question)

C

Fractions and decimals

1¼ = one and **a quarter**

1.25 = one **point** two five

1½ = one and **a half**

1.5 = one point five

1¾ = one and **three quarters**

1.75 = one point seven five

D

Percentages

26% is spoken as twenty-six **per cent**. More than 50% of something is the **majority of** it, less than 50% of something is the **minority**:

The **vast majority** of the students (e.g. 95%) agreed with the new plan, only a **small minority** (e.g. 5%) were unhappy.

E

Calculations

There are four basic processes. Notice how they are said when we are **working out** [trying to **calculate**] the answer.

+ = **addition**

e.g. 6 + 4 = 10 (six **plus/and** four **equals/is** ten)

– = **subtraction**

e.g. 6 – 4 = 2 (six **minus** four is two)

x = **multiplication**

e.g. 6 x 4 = 24 (six **multiplied by / times** four is twenty-four)

÷ = **division**

e.g. 8 ÷ 2 = 4 (eight **divided by** two is four)

Some people are not very good at **adding up** numbers [putting numbers together to reach a total], and often **get stuck** [have a problem] if they have to work out something quite difficult. The easiest way is to use a **calculator** [a small electronic machine for working out numbers].

F

Saying '0'

'0' can be spoken in different ways in different situations:

telephone number: 603449 = six **oh** three, **double** four nine OR six **zero** three, **double** four nine

mathematics: 0.7 = **nought** point seven; 6.02 = six point **oh** two OR six point **nought** two

temperature: –10 degrees = ten degrees below **zero** OR **minus** ten degrees